

## Driving Growth: Identifying Key Business Insights

### Data Analyst:

Jenny Core-Holt

### Client/Sponsor:

Head of Operations at Elist

### Purpose:

The purpose of this project is to analyse order and sales data from 2019 to 2022 to support the upcoming company-wide town hall presentation at Elist.

The analysis will provide actionable insights into:

- Overall sales performance and trends
- Monthly and yearly growth rates
- Refund rates and average order value (AOV)
- Loyalty programme performance and effectiveness

The findings will enable the Operations and Sales teams to make informed, data-driven decisions and evaluate current business strategies.

### Scope / Major Project Activities:

| Activity                      | Description                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
|-------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Define our Business Questions | <p>After following up with Angie to clarify requirements and definitions:</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Focus on sales, average order value (AOV), and order count for growth rates</li><li>• For loyalty program performance, also look at average order value</li><li>• For refunds and average order value, would like to focus on how these metrics compare across Apple products. Also include number of refunds as a metric</li></ul> |

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|----------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Data Collection & Credibility Check    | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Acquire and organise the Elist dataset</li> <li>Assess data completeness, consistency, and reliability</li> <li>Identify limitations, potential biases, and data quality issues</li> <li>Document assumptions and constraints</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| Data Clean Up & Documentation          | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Clean and transform data using Excel and SQL</li> <li>Handle missing or inconsistent values</li> <li>Standardise formats and validate data accuracy</li> <li>Ensure data integrity across tables and sources</li> <li>Document all data preparation steps for transparency and reproducibility</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| User Segmentation & Behavioural Trends | <p>Conduct descriptive and exploratory data analysis (EDA)</p> <p>North Star Metrics:</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Number of orders</li> <li>Total sales in dollars</li> <li>Average order value (AOV)</li> <li>Time to ship</li> <li>Time to deliver</li> <li>Refund rate</li> </ul> <p>Key Dimensions:</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Time (month, quarter, year)</li> <li>Geography (country, region, currency)</li> <li>Product (item, brand)</li> <li>User (marketing channel, account creation method, account creation date, loyalty program)</li> <li>Platform (purchase platform, registration platform)</li> </ul> <p>** has particular interest in Apple products.</p> |
| Create Growth Strategy Recommendations | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Develop clear and impactful data visualisations</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |

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|----------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                            | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Translate analysis into business insights and implications</li><li>• Provide three high-level strategic recommendations across:<ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>○ Sales</li><li>○ Operations</li><li>○ Marketing</li></ul></li></ul> |
| Deliver final presentation | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Summarise key findings, insights, and recommendations</li><li>• Ensure content is tailored for a non-technical audience</li><li>• Deliver final report and presentation materials</li></ul>                                               |

**This project does not include:**

- Predictive modelling or forecasting beyond descriptive trend analysis
- Implementation of recommendations or operational changes
- Real-time data pipeline development or automation
- Analysis of data outside the 2019–2022 timeframe
- Deep customer-level personal data analysis beyond aggregated insights

**Deliverables:**

| Deliverable                  | Description/ Details                                 |
|------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|
| Cleaned Dataset              | Structured and validated dataset ready for analysis  |
| Data Cleaning Documentation  | Record of all data preparation steps and assumptions |
| Exploratory Analysis Outputs | Summary of key trends, metrics, and findings         |

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|--------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|
| Data Visualisations      | Charts and dashboards illustrating key insights |
| Executive Summary Report | Concise summary of findings and recommendations |

#### Schedule Overview / Major Milestones:

| Milestone                                      | Expected Completion Date | Description/Details                               |
|------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|
| Project Kick-off & Requirements Finalisation   | Week 1                   | Confirm scope, objectives, and business questions |
| Data Collection & Assessment                   | Week 1                   | Acquire dataset and assess quality                |
| <i>Data Cleaning &amp; Preparation</i>         | Week 1                   | Clean, transform, and document dataset            |
| <i>Exploratory Data Analysis</i>               | Week 2                   | Identify trends and generate insights             |
| <i>Visualisation &amp; Insight Development</i> | Week 3                   | Create charts and develop recommendations         |
| <i>Final Presentation Preparation</i>          | Week 3                   | Build presentation and executive summary          |
| <i>Final Delivery</i>                          | Week 4                   | Deliver presentation and report to stakeholders   |

\*Estimated date for completion:

15th May 2026